Computer Science Paper Pre-Submission Checklist

Final review before sending a paper for peer review or conference/journal submission

Use this on the final PDF, not only on the source files. After checking every item, open the exact uploaded PDF once more and verify it matches what you intended to submit.

1. Core message and structure

- [ ] Title is specific and matches the actual contribution.
- [ ] Abstract states the problem, method, main result, and why it matters.
- [ ] Introduction motivates the problem and ends with explicit contributions.
- [ ] Claims are calibrated; no overstatement or unsupported novelty claims.
- [ ] Related work covers the most relevant prior methods, datasets, and benchmarks.
- [ ] Symbols, assumptions, and terminology are defined before use.

2. Experiments and technical soundness

- [ ] Baselines are strong, current, and fairly implemented.
- [ ] Metrics are appropriate, clearly defined, and reported consistently.
- [ ] Key implementation details, datasets, splits, and hyperparameters are documented.
- [ ] At least one ablation or sensitivity analysis supports the main claims.
- [ ] Each major claim in the paper is backed by a figure, table, or result.
- [ ] Limitations, failure cases, and ethics/societal impact are addressed if required.

3. Writing, grammar, and style

- [ ] Acronyms are expanded at first use.
- [ ] Terminology, notation, capitalization, tense, and voice are consistent.
- [ ] Sentences are concise; remove filler, repetition, and vague wording.
- [ ] Check spelling, typos, punctuation, commas, articles, and subject-verb agreement.
- [ ] Remove contractions, colloquial phrases, and unsupported adjectives.
- [ ] Search for doubled words, missing words, and broken cross-references.
- [ ] Read the title, abstract, section headings, and captions as a standalone summary.

4. Figures, references, and submission safety

- [ ] Every figure, table, and equation is referenced and explained in the text.
- [ ] Captions state the takeaway, not only what is shown.
- [ ] Axes, units, legends, and fonts are readable in grayscale and when printed.
- [ ] Every in-text citation appears in the bibliography; bibliography entries are complete. No hallucinated or fabricated references.
- [ ] Remove TODO/FIXME notes, tracked changes, comments, and debug text.
- [ ] Blind-review rules, page limits, and formatting rules match the venue.
- [ ] The uploaded PDF opens correctly; links, fonts, metadata, and supplement files are checked.

Last 5-minute search pass

- [ ] TODO / FIXME / XXX / ??
- [ ] doubled words and duplicate spaces
- [ ] self-identifying names, links, or metadata
- [ ] missing citations, broken references, and numbering mismatches

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Suggested GitHub tools for the final pass: cs-paper-checklist | Paper-Linter | textidote | codespell | submission_checklist